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Media and Environmental Resilience of Muslim Communities: A Community Development Perspective on Islam Channel's YouTube Content

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Abstract: This study examines environmental communication on the UK-based Islam Channel's YouTube platform and its relevance to community development and the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs). It combines a systematic literature review and bibliometric mapping with qualitative content analysis of 18 videos uploaded in 2023–2024, using NVivo 14 to analyse social, economic, and environmental themes. Of 99 coding assignments, 53 concerned social themes (54%), 35 economic themes (35%), and 11 environmental themes (11%). Environmental content formed the smallest share and frequently appeared within conflict-related humanitarian reporting, including accounts of damaged infrastructure and restricted access to water and other resources. These patterns suggest opportunities to give environmental issues a more sustained place in faith-based programming. The discussion relates this opportunity to Muslim communities facing climate and water-related challenges and explores Islamic concepts of khalifah fil ardh, mizan, fasad, and hima as resources for future environmental communication. Recommendations focus on editorial goals, culturally relevant narratives, solution-oriented reporting, partnerships, and evidence-informed content planning. The study offers a community development perspective on faith-based media and an agenda for strengthening its environmental communication.

Keywords: Community development; Faith-based media; Environmental communication; Muslim communities; Climate resilience; Sustainable Development Goals

1. Introduction

Community development concerns the ways in which people mobilise shared resources and build the capacity to improve social and environmental wellbeing. Environmental communication contributes to this process by making risks, responsibilities, and possible responses visible in public life. Media reporting shapes how these issues are understood and discussed (Boykoff & Boykoff, 2007), providing a resource for environmental knowledge and collective engagement. The availability and framing of environmental information therefore offer a useful starting point for examining the contribution of digital media to community development.

Faith-based media can connect environmental messages with the moral and ethical traditions of religious communities (Jenkins, 2010). This potential is relevant to Muslim communities in climate-vulnerable regions, including parts of South Asia, Southeast Asia, the Middle East, and Sub-Saharan Africa. Reports by the Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change (IPCC) highlight heat stress, water insecurity, sea-level rise, and

agricultural disruption as risks affecting everyday community life (IPCC, 2023a; IPCC, 2023b). Examining how Islamic media address these issues can clarify the resources their content offers for public discussion and environmental understanding.

The UK-based Islam Channel provides a case for exploring these questions through its YouTube content. Environmental communication research highlights relationships among media, public understanding, and engagement with climate issues (Moser, 2010; Pearce et al., 2019). Faith-based broadcasting also offers relevant examples: DeHanas (2009) examined an environmental radio campaign involving Muslim women in London. The present study extends this discussion by examining the place of environmental themes alongside social and economic concerns in a selected Islam Channel video corpus.

Islamic theological traditions contain several resources for this discussion. *Khalifah fil ardh* (stewardship on Earth) provides a normative basis for ecological responsibility at individual and community levels (Izzi Dien, 2000). *Fasad*, understood as corruption or destruction, offers an ethical basis for opposing environmental damage, while *hima* (protected areas) informs community-based natural resource management (Faruqui et al., 2001). These ideas connect with broader discussions of religious actors and sustainable development (Palmer & Finlay, 2003). Their relevance to environmental communication lies in the possibility of relating ecological knowledge to values and practices familiar to Muslim communities.

The study has three objectives: to compare environmental, social and economic related to the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) themes in the selected videos; to examine the narrative contexts of environmental content; and to develop recommendations for community-oriented environmental communication on faith-based digital media.

The analytical framework developed for this study adopts a community development perspective focused on environmental knowledge conveyed through media, its cultural and normative framing, and opportunities for discussion and action around shared responsibilities. Sustainability governance provides a broader institutional context (Biermann et al., 2012). The literature review and bibliometric map situate the video analysis within faith-based media, environmental communication and the SDGs.

2. Materials and Methods

2.1 Research Design

The study combines qualitative content analysis with a systematic literature review and exploratory bibliometric mapping. The literature components establish the research context and inform interpretation, while the video analysis provides the primary empirical material for examining SDG themes and their implications for community-oriented environmental communication. The SDG framework guided video coding.

Combining bibliometric mapping with qualitative literature synthesis has methodological parallels in digital-platform research (Schüler & Petrik, 2021). Research on climate journalism also informs the study's attention to thematic coverage and narrative context (Schäfer & Painter, 2021).

2.2 Qualitative Approach

The qualitative approach supports close attention to meaning and context in media content (Creswell & Sinley, 2017). The analysis examines the frequency of coded themes and the ways in which selected examples relate environmental concerns to community life, drawing on environmental communication research (Mahl & Guenther, 2023).

2.3 Research Setting and Video Selection

Islam Channel's YouTube channel was purposively selected as a case of faith-based digital broadcasting. Its coverage of social, economic, and environmental issues offers a basis for comparing SDG-related themes within a defined sample of media content.

The sample comprised 18 videos uploaded in 2023–2024 and selected through a review of the channel's upload history in February 2025. Videos were eligible when their title or on-screen description indicated substantive attention to at least one social, economic, or environmental SDG theme and a transcript or reliable subtitle track was available. Purely devotional, liturgical, or entertainment videos without a discernible SDG-related theme were excluded. Full source details, upload dates, durations, and transcript languages are provided in Table A1 in the Appendix.

Screening began with video titles using terms organised around the three dimensions: environmental terms such as climate, water, environment, and sustainability; economic terms such as economy, poverty, development, and livelihood; and social terms such as education, health, justice, and community. The dialogue or transcript of potentially relevant videos was then checked for substantive SDG content. Only the 18 included videos were

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retained in the selection record. Selection was based on thematic relevance rather than running time. Transcripts were imported into NVivo 14 for coding.

The unit of coding was a discrete transcript segment, typically one to several sentences, addressing a social, economic, or environmental theme. A segment could receive more than one dimension code when its content spanned multiple themes. The environmental assignments were subsequently reviewed against the operational definition, yielding a final total of 11 environmental, 35 economic, and 53 social references. Percentages use the resulting 99 coding assignments as the denominator.

Segment boundaries followed topic continuity. A continuous discussion of one topic was retained as a single reference even when it extended across several sentences; a new reference began when the topic or SDG dimension shifted. Greetings, transitional remarks, and material unrelated to the three dimensions were left uncoded.

Environmental coding included conflict-related damage and resource conditions discussed in the Gaza videos, such as white-phosphorus munitions, damaged infrastructure, and restricted access to food and water. This approach recognises environmental harm within humanitarian and political narratives, drawing on the relationship between natural resources and armed conflict (Le Billon, 2001). It encompasses both environmental content embedded in conflict reporting and content devoted more directly to environmental issues.

2.4 Literature Review and Bibliometric Mapping

Scopus and Web of Science were searched in February 2025. The Scopus export contained 591 English-language records from 2021–2025; filtering by publication year and title/abstract relevance retained 251. These were combined with 50 Web of Science records to form the 301-record bibliometric dataset. Before literature screening, 14 duplicates identified in EndNote 21 were manually confirmed and removed (Figure 1).

Both databases used the following Boolean query, applied to TITLE-ABS-KEY in Scopus and TS in Web of Science: (“climate change” OR “environmental communication” OR “water resource”) AND (“Islamic media” OR “faith-based media” OR “Islam”) AND (“sustainable development goal*” OR “SDG” OR “sustainable development” OR “community development”).

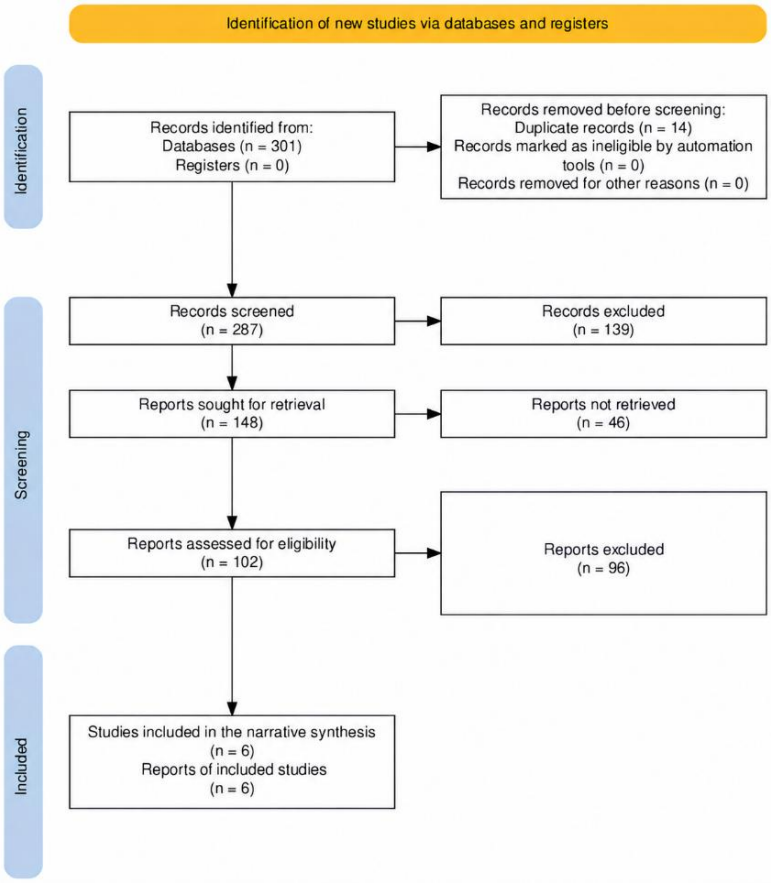


Figure 1. Literature selection flowchart

Table A2 and Table A3 in the Appendix summarise the six studies included in the narrative synthesis and six background references. The background references are not counted among the studies included in Figure 1.

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Eligibility required an Islamic/faith-based media focus (criterion 1) or an environmental-communication focus (criterion 2), together with SDG relevance.

The SDG connection could be explicit in the original study or identified through thematic mapping by the present authors. Al Shogran et al. (2024), Elmarai et al. (2013), and Khan et al. (2021) use the latter basis, as identified in Table A3 in the Appendix. Each meets the faith-based-media criterion, while the six background records remain outside the scope of the formal synthesis.

Figure 2 presents the VOSviewer 1.6.20 term co-occurrence map based on the titles and abstracts of 301 records, using full counting and a minimum occurrence of three. No additional thesaurus or exclusion list was applied. Node size represents term frequency, link thickness co-occurrence strength, and colour cluster membership. The green cluster covers environmental and economic sustainability, the blue cluster social indicators and SDG targets, and the red cluster education and institutional sustainability.

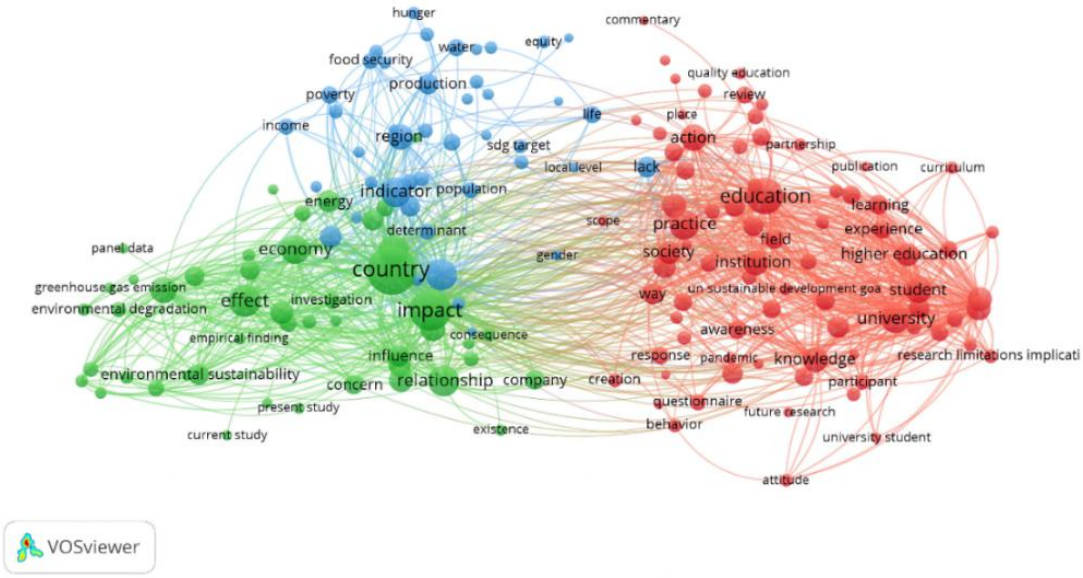


Figure 2. Term co-occurrence map of research on the Sustainable Development Goals
Note: The map uses 301 records, including 14 duplicate records retained in the bibliometric dataset but removed before literature screening. It serves as exploratory background to the literature review.

The six eligible studies contribute complementary perspectives (see Table A2 and Table A3 in the Appendix). Four address Islamic or faith-based media in relation to education (Elmarai et al., 2013), philanthropy (Makhrus, 2018), freedom of expression (Khan et al., 2021), and digital addiction (Al Shogran et al., 2024). Two add environmental perspectives through the ecological dimension of small and medium-sized enterprise (SME) digital platforms (Isensee et al., 2025) and media strategies for environmental awareness (Mialkovska et al., 2024). The six background records concern broader relationships among digitalisation, media, education, and the SDGs (Abbas & Zaman, 2024; Almawla et al., 2025; De Luca et al., 2022; Rukiyati et al., 2025; Shao & Yin, 2025; Xu, 2022). Across the 12 assessed records, none examines Islamic media content through all three SDG dimensions simultaneously. This synthesis motivates a closer examination of environmental themes alongside social and economic concerns in the selected video corpus.

2.5 Data Analysis

Qualitative analysis followed the iterative approach of Miles & Huberman (1994), with NVivo 14 used to organise transcripts and coding. Three parent dimensions social, economic, and environmental aspects were defined from the SDG framework, with thematic interpretation refined as the transcripts were read.

Coding was conducted by one researcher, with consistency checked through time-delayed re-coding and discussion with co-authors. Thematic frequencies are reported as counts of coding assignments. Individual SDG numbers are used as interpretive mappings in the discussion rather than separate NVivo child-node counts. Table A4 in the Appendix provides the full codebook.

Environmental aspects concern tangible environmental damage or resource conditions, including chemical

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contamination, water and sanitation infrastructure, ecosystems, and resource scarcity. Economic aspects concern livelihoods, income, costs, and material hardship or capacity. Social aspects concern community wellbeing, education, displacement, identity, rights, and civic or political participation. These dimensions are mapped respectively to the environmental SDGs 6, 7, 13, 14, and 15; SDG 1 for the economic content identified; and SDGs 16, 10, 1, and 11 for the social content.

The relative frequency of environmental coding was compared descriptively with social and economic coding. Selected passages and cases were then interpreted in terms of the environmental knowledge, cultural connections, and practical concerns they brought into community-oriented reporting.

2.6 Audience Engagement and Sentiment Analysis

Public engagement data for the 18 videos were collected through the YouTube Data API v3 on 8 September 2026. The videos.list endpoint (part = statistics) supplied view counts, likes, and total comments; commentThreads.list supplied top-level comments ordered by relevance, up to a maximum of 100 per video. This yielded 801 comments, with a mean of 44.5 per video and a range of 2–100. Two videos yielded fewer than five sampled comments, and none had commenting disabled. Public dislike counts were unavailable, so likes, comments, and sentiment were reported separately.

Comment sentiment was analysed using VADER (Valence Aware Dictionary and sEntiment Reasoner), a lexicon- and rule-based tool for short social-media text (Hutto & Gilbert, 2014). Compound scores range from −1 to +1. Scores of at least 0.05 were classified as positive, scores of −0.05 or less as negative, and intermediate scores as neutral. For each video, the mean compound score and the percentages of positive and negative comments were calculated. Approximately 7% of sampled comments were in languages other than English, primarily Arabic and Albanian. For these comments, the automated assessment relied on emojis and punctuation recognised by VADER.

3. Results and Discussion

3.1 Sustainable Development Goals Themes in Video Samples

NVivo 14 was used to examine the distribution of social, economic, and environmental themes in the 18-video sample. Figure 3 summarizes the coding assignments accoss the treee dimensions.

Social welfare, education, and Gaza-related political and humanitarian issues feature prominently in the sample. Environmental issues receive less attention and are often discussed within these wider concerns, pointing to opportunities to develop more sustained coverage of climate, water security, and ecological systems.

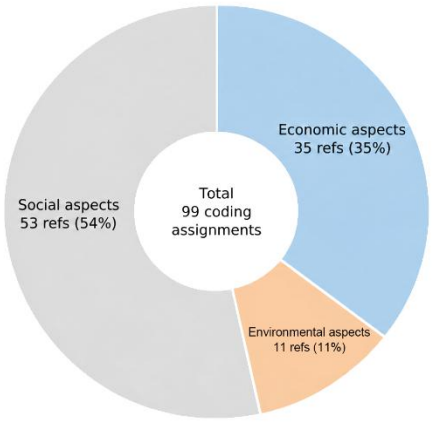


Figure 3. Coding assignments across the dimensions of the Sustainable Development Goals

3.2 Environmental Communication and Community Development

Environmental themes account for 11 of the 99 coding assignments (11%), compared with 35 economic assignments (35%) and 53 social assignments (54%; Figure 3). This distribution makes environmental communication the least represented dimension in the sample and provides a starting point for considering how faith-based media could give environmental knowledge a more prominent place in community-oriented programming. Environmental communication research emphasizes the importance of media coverage in making climate and sustainability issues visible and meaningful to the public (Moser, 2010; Pearce et al., 2019; Schäfer & Painter, 2021). Faith-based media can contribute to this process by connecting environmental information with

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religious values and everyday community concerns (Jenkins, 2010). Such communication also needs to remain attentive to differences within faith-based audiences, since religiosity does not have a uniformly positive relationship with media trust (Golan & Day, 2010).

Environmental justice adds a further dimension to this discussion. Communities in South Asia, Southeast Asia, the Middle East, and Sub-Saharan Africa face serious climate-related risks, including heat stress, water insecurity, sea-level rise, and disruption to agriculture (IPCC, 2023a). Coverage that connects these risks with local livelihoods and practical responses would strengthen the relevance of environmental reporting to Muslim communities in climate-vulnerable settings.

3.3 Illustrative Cases and Sustainable Development Goals Connections

Three videos listed in Table 1 illustrate different connections between the SDGs and community concerns. The ICJ-submission video (Video 9) links to SDGs 16, 10, 3, 6, and 17, with Palestinian access to water and sanitation providing a clear environmental connection within a humanitarian and legal account. The Deir el-Balah video (Video 6) describes repeated displacement and the loss of stable settlement and community infrastructure, connecting with SDGs 1, 10, 11, and 16. The Victoria Derbyshire debate (Video 12) concerns political representation among British Muslims and links to SDGs 16 and 10. Together, these examples show how social, political, and environmental concerns can enter community-oriented reporting through different narrative contexts.

Table 1. Coding assignments by video and dimension of the Sustainable Development Goals

ID	Abbreviated Title and Source URL	Env. Refs	Econ. Refs	Social Refs	Total Coding Assignments	Env. IDs
1	"Amid Gaza's Famine" (https://youtu.be/IaKbhqiALfU)	2	6	6	14	ENV01, ENV02
2	"Palestinian Teacher Brings Hajj to Gazan Kids" (https://youtu.be/r8Nzj0LmJJk)	0	1	4	5	—
3	"Glyn Secker – No Country Beyond Criticism" (https://youtu.be/FAzPUSDDpfk)	0	1	2	3	—
4	"Israel White Phosphorus Bombs on UNRWA School" (https://youtu.be/Vb866Xg_56g)	2	0	3	5	ENV08, ENV09
5	"Lowkey on Gaza" (https://youtu.be/BeypyyPCdlU)	2	2	4	8	ENV10, ENV11
6	"Displaced Gazans Flee Deir El-Balah" (https://youtu.be/ckc2zq8BueU)	0	2	4	6	—
7	"Leanne Mohamad: We Will Never Be Silenced" (https://youtu.be/Q-3JFzBWXwU)	0	2	3	5	—
8	"Holocaust Survivors' Descendant" (https://youtu.be/zOzCKxTznTE)	0	1	4	5	—
9	"SA Ambassador at ICJ" (https://youtu.be/HICA-lHoV20)	1	2	4	7	ENV16
10	"Gazan Man's Family Killed" (https://youtu.be/bILv3iH4Fzw)	1	3	2	6	ENV19
11	"World Failing to Call Out Israel" (https://youtu.be/QfwVvOBrB6A)	1	1	2	4	ENV20
12	"Victoria Derbyshire vs Tory MP" (https://youtu.be/0fQaNyjcGiw)	0	2	2	4	—
13	"ICJ: What Did It Tell Israel" (https://youtu.be/cuZcj9DIF8c)	0	1	1	2	—
14	"British Muslim Youths on Palestine" (https://youtu.be/KMUaodcxGEU)	0	3	4	7	—
15	"SA Legal Team Lawyer's Statement" (https://youtu.be/zeqB9Mk3UuE)	2	4	3	9	ENV22, ENV23
16	"James O'Brien Debate on Arms Sales" (https://youtu.be/MUPPR0U4J4A)	0	2	3	5	—
17	"SA President Ramaphosa on ICJ Ruling" (https://youtu.be/-exqRGemDtc)	0	1	1	2	—
18	"Marieha Hussain's Prosecution" (https://youtu.be/TsIH6Fsg-Bg)	0	1	1	2	—
Total	18 videos	11 (11%)	35 (35%)	53 (54%)	99	—

Note: Env. = environmental; Econ. = economic; refs = coding references; "—" = not appliable. A transcript segment may receive more than one dimension code. Percentages use 99 assignments (11 + 35 + 53). Environmental references occur in 7 videos, economic references in 17, and social references in all 18. Full video titles and sources are in Table A1; environmental evidence IDs refer to Table A5.

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All 7 videos containing environmental references also contain social references, and 6 of the 7 contain economic references (Table 1). The exception is the video on white-phosphorus munitions (Video 4), which contains environmental and social references. This shared-video pattern places environmental themes alongside the social and economic concerns already prominent in the sample. The relationship between environmental vulnerability and political conflict provides a useful context for interpreting these examples (Kelley et al., 2017). Conflict reporting can make environmental damage visible through its consequences for livelihoods, infrastructure, and daily life. It also offers an entry point for explaining longer-term issues such as resource protection, climate adaptation, and community recovery.

Water resource management illustrates this connection. Mekonnen & Hoekstra (2016) estimated that four billion people worldwide experience severe water scarcity for at least one month each year, while Schewe et al. (2014) projected growing water-scarcity pressures under climate change. Islamic traditions of hima (protected areas) and restrictions on water monopolization offer culturally resonant resources for community water governance (Faruqui et al., 2001). Connecting these ethical principles with water science could link immediate concerns about access and scarcity to long-term stewardship. For the present video analysis, Table A5 documents the 11 environmental coding references and their original evidence IDs, linking the coded passages to the counts in Table 1.

Table 2 summarises public engagement for the 18 videos and VADER sentiment scores for 801 sampled top-level comments. Data retrieved via the YouTube Data API v3 on 8 September 2026 showed totals of 640,008 views, 23,684 likes and 5,075 comments. Across the 18 videos, the unweighted mean of the video-level average compound sentiment scores was +0.17; the corresponding means of the positive- and negative-comment percentages were 54.6% and 26.4%. The Deir el-Balah displacement video (Video 6) had the fewest views (813) and the most negative average sentiment (−0.37), while the ICJ-submission video (Video 9) received 8,382 views and an average sentiment of +0.37. These measures describe responses to each video as a whole. Negative sentiment around humanitarian testimony may express distress, grief or disapproval concerning the events depicted, so it should not be treated as a direct measure of approval of the video.

Table 2. Video engagement and comment-sentiment metrics

No.	Abbreviated Title	Views	Likes	Comments in Total	Mean Sentiment	Positive (%)	Negative (%)
1	“Amid Gaza’s Famine”	2,123	186	32	−0.005	31.6%	36.8%
2	“Palestinian Teacher Brings Hajj to Gazan Kids”	1,421	107	19	0.586	92.9%	0.0%
3	“Glyn Secker – No Country Beyond Criticism”	3,701	165	22	0.102	41.7%	16.7%
4	“Israel White Phosphorus Bombs on UNRWA School”	3,704	241	47	−0.034	28.0%	44.0%
5	“Lowkey on Gaza”	8,629	474	35	0.190	64.7%	35.3%
6	“Displaced Gazans Flee Deir El-Balah”	813	56	6	−0.369	50.0%	50.0%
7	“Leanne Mohamad: We Will Never Be Silenced”	3,248	397	83	0.253	55.6%	16.7%
8	“Holocaust Survivors’ Descendant”	84,846	2,421	521	0.391	74.0%	13.0%
9	“SA Ambassador at ICJ”	8,382	536	50	0.374	66.7%	8.3%
10	“Gazan Man’s Family Killed”	4,156	231	63	−0.081	33.3%	40.5%
11	“World Failing to Call Out Israel”	249,472	11,807	1,847	0.261	60.0%	28.0%
12	“Victoria Derbyshire vs Tory MP”	106,835	2,154	873	0.034	32.0%	27.0%
13	“ICJ: What Did It Tell Israel”	1,197	45	21	0.345	77.8%	11.1%
14	“British Muslim Youths on Palestine”	1,681	140	55	0.189	50.0%	27.8%
15	“SA Legal Team Lawyer’s Statement”	99,379	2,287	570	0.422	73.0%	19.0%
16	“James O’Brien Debate on Arms Sales”	48,025	1,797	579	0.054	44.0%	37.0%
17	“SA President Ramaphosa on ICJ Ruling”	3,639	275	68	0.401	70.8%	20.8%
18	“Marieha Hussain’s Prosecution”	8,757	365	184	−0.030	37.1%	42.9%

Note: VADER compound scores range from −1 to +1. Sentiment analysis used up to 100 top-level comments per video, ordered by relevance (801 comments in total). The comments column reports all comments recorded for each video. Data were retrieved through the YouTube Data API v3 on 8 September 2026.

3.4 Faith-Based Media as a Community Development Resource

3.4.1 Environmental communication and community knowledge

This study connects the distribution of environmental themes in faith-based digital media with the knowledge and cultural resources available for community development. Within the broader agenda of sustainability governance (Biermann et al., 2012), media can provide a space for relating environmental problems to shared responsibilities and practical responses. The comparatively small environmental share in the sample therefore invites attention to how programming could more consistently connect ecological concerns with community life.

From this perspective, the contribution of faith-based media depends on the breadth, continuity, and practical

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relevance of its environmental reporting, as well as the balance among SDG themes. The priorities below build on the observed content pattern by linking editorial planning with community concerns and Islamic environmental ethics.

3.4.2 Islamic theological resources

Islamic environmental ethics offer resources for developing this approach. *Khalifah fil ardh* (stewardship on Earth) provides a theological basis for ecological responsibility (Izzi Dien, 2000), while the prohibition of *fa*sad (corruption or destruction) supports opposition to environmentally damaging practices. *Mizan* (balance) connects with ecological interdependence and sustainability, and *hima* (protected areas) provides a model for community-based natural resource governance relevant to water security and biodiversity conservation (Faruqui et al., 2001).

These concepts are proposed as resources for future content development. Integrated with scientific explanations and local examples, they can connect environmental stewardship with values familiar to Muslim communities. This approach offers a practical way to develop reporting that is scientifically informed, culturally relevant, and attentive to community priorities.

3.4.3 Environmental content planning

The study also illustrates how bibliometric mapping and qualitative content analysis can inform environmental communication planning. VOSviewer provides a view of the relevant scholarly landscape, while NVivo supports a closer examination of the selected media content. Used together, these approaches connect research context with editorial questions about thematic coverage and opportunities for future programming.

4. Challenges for Environmental Communication

Developing this approach involves several practical challenges for editorial planning and communication. The first is to give environmental issues a more consistent place alongside social and economic reporting. The distribution observed in the sample suggests room to expand both the range and continuity of coverage, including stories on water, energy, biodiversity, and climate adaptation that connect with everyday community concerns.

A related challenge is to build on the environmental dimensions of conflict and humanitarian reporting. Stories about damaged infrastructure, displacement, and resource scarcity offer opportunities to connect immediate needs with longer-term questions of environmental recovery and governance.

Accessibility and cultural relevance also matter. Collaboration with community organizations and educators can help adapt environmental information to different levels of digital access and local knowledge. Relating environmental issues to livelihoods, public health, and Islamic ethical principles provides several routes for making coverage meaningful to diverse Muslim communities.

5. Research Limitations

The findings reflect 18 purposively selected videos and the judgments of one principal coder, supported by time-delayed re-coding and co-author discussion. The literature screening was also conducted by a single researcher. Separate logs of excluded video candidates and the preliminary Scopus filtering decisions were not retained. The sample does not represent the channel's full output, and translation may affect interpretation. Engagement metrics describe whole videos, while VADER has limited sensitivity to non-English comments and to the objects of expressed emotions. Community resilience and audience responses to the proposed strategies were not directly assessed. The study's contribution is to identify a pattern of content and develop an agenda for further editorial and audience research.

6. Recommendations for Community Environmental Communication

The analysis suggests the following priorities for strengthening environmental communication on Islam Channel's YouTube platform.

Set editorial goals for environmental coverage. Establish practical goals for greater consistency, depth, and thematic diversity, with attention to renewable energy (SDG 7), biodiversity (SDG 15), water resources (SDG 6), and climate change (SDG 13). Progress can be reviewed over time through the relevance of coverage to community concerns and the range of issues addressed.

Connect environmental reporting with Islamic ethics. Use khalifah, mizan, fasad, and hima to frame discussions of ecological stewardship, water conservation, and climate change. Collaboration with Islamic environmental scholars and organizations such as the Islamic Foundation for Ecology and Environmental Sciences (IFEES) can help integrate theological perspectives with scientific information.

Develop solution-oriented reporting. Alongside coverage of environmental problems, present practical responses and community experiences of water conservation, renewable energy, and climate adaptation.

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Connecting risks with feasible action can make environmental communication more useful to communities (Moser, 2010). Build on links among environmental, economic, and social issues. Reporting on Gaza and other humanitarian concerns can give greater attention to water infrastructure, resource scarcity, and environmental recovery alongside displacement and livelihoods. This approach develops environmental coverage through subjects already prominent in the analysed videos.

Develop environmental partnerships. Explore collaboration with United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP), IPCC Communications Office, national environmental agencies, and civil society organizations, in line with SDG 17. These relationships could support access to scientific expertise, visual materials, and community-focused reporting opportunities. Use evidence to guide content planning. Combine periodic content analysis with audience research to review coverage, identify emerging concerns, and refine programming. NVivo can support the assessment of thematic patterns, while community feedback can help editors understand the relevance and clarity of environmental messages.

Support environmental literacy and access. Work with educational institutions, digital literacy initiatives, and community organizations to make environmental information accessible in settings with limited digital infrastructure. Materials adapted to local needs and communication practices can extend the practical value of the channel's environmental reporting.

7. Conclusions

Across 18 Islam Channel YouTube videos, environmental themes accounted for 11% of the 99 coding assignments, compared with 54% for social themes and 35% for economic themes. Environmental communication thus formed the smallest part of the sample's SDG-related content. The study interprets this pattern from a community development perspective, emphasizing the value of linking environmental knowledge with the social concerns and cultural resources already present in faith-based media.

The environmental references frequently appeared within humanitarian and conflict reporting. These connections provide a useful basis for extending coverage from immediate damage and resource needs to water governance, ecological recovery, and climate adaptation. Editorial planning can build on this relationship while creating space for a broader range of environmental stories.

Islamic concepts of stewardship, balance, protection, and responsibility offer a culturally grounded resource for this work. Bringing these principles together with scientific knowledge and community experience can help shape environmental reporting that connects faith, practical concerns, and the SDGs.

This study proposes five practical priorities for strengthening faith-based media's contribution to the 2030 SDG agenda: more consistent environmental coverage, theologically informed narratives, solution-oriented journalism, partnerships, and evidence-informed planning.

Future studies can develop this agenda through comparisons across Islamic media platforms, longitudinal tracking of environmental coverage, and research on audience interpretation and community responses. Examining how editorial decisions and platform conditions shape environmental reporting would also help connect content patterns with the processes behind them.

Author Contributions

Conceptualization, N.H. and M.F.; methodology, N.H.; software, N.A.N. and A.M.F.; validation, N.H. and M.F.; formal analysis, D.B.; investigation, N.H.; resources, S.H.; data curation, N.H.; writing—original draft preparation, H.R.; writing—review and editing, H.R.; visualization, N.H.; supervision, H.M.; project administration, N.H.; funding acquisition, N.H. All authors have read and approved the submitted manuscript.

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Data Availability

Data supporting this study are available from the corresponding author upon reasonable request.

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framework, and content-analysis data. This article focuses on environmental communication and develops an Islamic environmental-ethics perspective and associated recommendations.

Conflicts of Interest

The authors declare no conflicts of interest.

Declaration on the Use of Generative AI and AI-assisted Technologies

The authors state that no generative artificial intelligence (AI) or AI-assisted technology was used in preparing the manuscript they submitted for editorial consideration. The authors remain responsible for the accuracy, originality, and integrity of the manuscript.

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Appendix

Table A1. Source details for the 18 analysed Islam Channel videos

ID	Video Title	Publication Date	Duration	Language	Inclusion Basis
1	Amid Gaza's famine, Palestinians forced to eat mulberry leaves [to eat animal fodder due to blockade]	28 Jul 2024	4:30	Arabic (translated)	Social/environmental: Food and water insecurity
2	Palestinian Teacher Brings Hajj [Ritual Simulation] to Gazan Kids	17 Jun 2024	3:26	Arabic (translated)	Social: Education and support for displaced children
3	Glyn Secker – "No Country in the World Should Be Beyond Criticism"	2 Nov 2023	1:52	English (original)	Social/political: Free speech and human rights
4	Israel Uses Internationally Banned White Phosphorus Bombs on UNRWA School in Gaza	11 Nov 2023	1:32	Arabic (translated)	Environmental/social: Chemical weapons and civilian impacts
5	Lowkey on Gaza: "Israel Has Practised Cruelty on an Industrial Scale"	1 Nov 2023	2:25	English (original)	Social/environmental: Water access and infant mortality

6	Displaced Gazans Flee Deir El-Balah After Israeli Evacuation Order	17 Aug 2024	1:49	Arabic (translated)	Social: Displacement and community disruption
7	Leanne Mohamad: “We Will Never Be Silenced”	16 Sep 2024	2:43	English (original)	Social/political: Arms sales and Palestinian rights
8	Holocaust Survivors’ Descendant: “They Are the Worst Form of Anti-Semites”	10 Sep 2024	3:04	English (original)	Social: Interfaith relations and historical memory
9	South Africa’s Ambassador to the Netherlands Lists the Measures Demanded by SA Against Israel at ICJ	16 Jan 2024	6:48	English (original)	Social: Water, sanitation and legal obligations
10	Gazan Man Realises Entire Family Killed by Israel After Getting Newborns’ Certificates	15 Aug 2024	3:12	Arabic (translated)	Social: Civilian casualties, displacement, and family loss
11	The World Is Responsible for Failing to Call Out the Reality of the Israeli Regime	2 Nov 2023	5:25	English (original)	Social/political: Accountability and sanctions
12	Victoria Derbyshire Tells Tory MP: “You've Just Singled Out the Muslim Community”	15 Sep 2024	3:54	English (original)	Social/political: British Muslim political participation
13	The International Court of Justice: What Did the ICJ Tell Israel to Do on “Gaza War”?	27 Jun 2024	4:34	English (original)	Social: Judicial proceedings and humanitarian aid
14	British Muslim Youths on Palestine	3 Aug 2024	4:34	English (original)	Social/political: Youth engagement and UK politics on Gaza
15	South Africa Legal Team Lawyer Praised for “Stunning” Closing Statement	13 Jan 2024	31:22	English (original)	Social: Humanitarian crisis and Genocide Convention argumentation
16	James O’Brien’s 12-Minute Debate With Caller on UK’s Arms Sales Suspension to Israel	13 Sep 2024	11:55	English (original)	Social/political: UK arms export and international law
17	South Africa’s President Cyril Ramaphosa Reacts to ICJ Ruling	27 Jan 2024	11:15	English (original)	Social: Diplomacy and humanitarian aid
18	Was Marieha Hussain’s Prosecution a Way to Silence and Intimidate Free Speech?	14 Sep 2024	11:15	English (original)	Social/political: Free speech and protest policing

Table A2. Study focus and eligibility decisions for the 12 assessed records

Reference	Study Focus	Role
Abbas & Zaman, 2024	Digitalisation and socio-economic SDGs in emerging economies	Background
Al Shogran et al., 2024	Islamic media and digital addiction among Jordanian media students	Included
Elmarai et al., 2013	Media management systems for Quran and Islamic education	Included
Khan et al., 2021	Free-speech discourse in Islamic and Western news media	Included
Makhrus, 2018	Social media and Islamic philanthropy in Indonesia	Included
Almawla et al., 2025	AI-based social media and policymaking for sustainable cities	Background
De Luca et al., 2022	Social media engagement and SDG communication	Background
Isensee et al., 2025	SME digital platforms and the SDGs	Included
Mialkovska et al., 2024	Media strategies for environmental awareness and sustainable development	Included
Shao & Yin, 2025	AI in media content creation for SDG communication	Background
Xu, 2022	Media framing of SDG-related grassroots activism in Macau	Background
Rukiyati et al., 2025	Folklore as a medium for character education and SDG 4 in Indonesia	Background

Note: SME = small and medium-sized enterprise.

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Table A3. Eligibility matrix for the 12 records assessed for narrative synthesis

Source	Criterion 1	Criterion 2	SDG Relevance	Eligible
Abbas & Zaman, 2024	No: Digitalisation and economics	No: Socio-economic SDGs	Explicit: SDGs 1, 8, and 10	No
Al Shogran et al., 2024	Yes: Islamic media	No: Health/addiction focus	Mapped: SDG 3	Yes
Elmarai et al., 2013	Yes: Quran/Islamic education media	No: Education focus	Mapped: SDG 4	Yes
Khan et al., 2021	Yes: Islamic news media	No: Free-speech focus	Mapped: SDG 16	Yes
Makhrus, 2018	Yes: Islamic philanthropy via social-media	No: Poverty/philanthropy focus	Explicit: SDGs 1 and 10	Yes
Almawla et al., 2025	No: General social media	No: Urban policy focus	Explicit: SDG 11	No
De Luca et al., 2022	No: General social media	No: Broad SDG communication	Explicit: General SDGs	No
Isensee et al., 2025	No: SME digital-platforms	Yes: Ecological dimension	Explicit: SDGs 2, 7, 8, 9, 12, 13, and 17	Yes
Mialkovska et al., 2024	No: General media and public relations study	Yes: Environmental awareness	Explicit: Sustainable development (general)	Yes
Shao & Yin, 2025	No: General AI-media	No: AI-generated content production	Mapped: General SDGs	No
Xu, 2022	No: General media-framing	No: General SDG activism	Explicit: General SDGs	No
Rukiyati et al., 2025	No: Folklore/education study	No: Education focus	Explicit: SDG 4	No

Note: Criterion 1 = Islamic/faith-based media focus; Criterion 2 = environmental-communication focus. Eligibility required either criterion 1 or criterion 2, together with SDG relevance. Explicit = identified in the original study; Mapped = thematic mapping by the present authors. Numbers identify SDGs. Records marked "No" were retained as background references. SME = small and medium-sized enterprise.

Table A4. Codebook for the three main coding dimensions

Dimension	SDGs	Coding Definition	Positive Example	Boundary Example
Environmental	6, 7, 13, 14, 15	Tangible environmental damage or resource conditions, including contamination, water/sanitation infrastructure and resource scarcity, assessed under the conflict-context coding rule.	Video 4: phosphorus contamination.	Video 15: school non-attendance (Social)
Economic	1	Livelihoods, income, costs, or material economic hardship or capacity.	Video 1: lack of money.	Video 4: chemical harm, with no Economic coding
Social	16, 10, 1, 11	Community wellbeing, education, displacement, identity, rights, and civic or political participation.	Video 2: education and support for displaced children.	Video 15: sewage overflow (Environmental)

Note: SDG links reflect thematic interpretation. Examples summarise coded transcript segments.

Table A5. Register of the 11 environmental coding references

Env. ID	Video ID	Coded Passage	Coverage (%)
ENV01	1	"the destruction, the bombing, and the destroyed floor"	1.92
ENV02	1	"We washed and filtered it, when we came, we put it in salty water so that it boils so that the children can accept it, because it means that no one would accept its taste or color."	2.97
ENV08	4	"They are stuck with phosphorus."	4.18
ENV09	4	"This is the only way to turn off the phosphorus."	6.61
ENV10	5	"You're looking at 95% of the water is not fit for human consumption."	3.36
ENV11	5	"You're talking about a place where the electricity the sky the water the fuel the food the medical equipment the medicine."	5.97
ENV16	9	"the deprivation of access to adequate food and water"	1.12
ENV19	10	"They called me and told me that the house you are in was bombed. People from the neighborhood were bombed. My wife, my two children, and my mother-in-law went away."	10.00
ENV20	11	"Children are being slaughtered uh by their artillery their Relentless bombardment of residential complexes of hospitals of schools uh of Civilian infrastructure."	3.87
ENV22	15	"A public health disaster is unfolding infectious diseases are spreading in overcrowded shelters."	0.42
ENV23	15	"sewers spill over"	0.08

Note: Env. = environmental. Video IDs correspond to Table 1 and Table A1; transcript languages are listed in Table A1. Coverage values are from NVivo. Evidence IDs and passages retain the original export labels and wording, except ENV02, which uses the full transcript wording verified by the authors.

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